

Vozes sem Corpo - RUN

Compiled table document. Source files remain authoritative. Rebuild this file when

reviewed prep changes. This is preparation, not session history.

Runtime header

Field	Value
System	SWADE Fifth Printing (2023)
Rank	Novice
Players	1
PC mode	player-supplied (Lilly Dawson)
Active setting modules	none
Supernatural level	subtle presentation; no supernatural truth
Historical accuracy	cinematic late-January 1986 texture; fictional Ashgrove
House rules	HR-NFA-001, HR-NFA-002
Expected runtime	3–5 hours
Compilation date	2026-09-07
Verified by	Co-GM source review; QUALITY 108/120, coherence passed

Not a scene script. Jump to the situation on the table: SP1 102.3 FM; SP2 Records; SP3 Town Witnesses; SP4 Water Authority; SP5 Tower Compound; SP6 Disposition. Payload lives in the named story point or lookup. First 15 minutes and Climax situation are indexes only.

Table terms

Term	Means
Original	A source reel, recorder track, paper log, or machine state with documentable custody; copies remain useful but may be challenged.
Synchronization gap	The same precise interval absent from independent records. It proves common process, not motive, culprit, or ownership.
Cleanup step	After the crew is alerted, one category Cal/Ray destroys or moves at the compound: paper log, signal head, Frank's body, then escape. Alert starts the clock but does not itself erase a category.
Protected evidence	Any item, copy, testimony, or notation Lilly has already secured; later failure does not retroactively erase it.

Notation

Rule	This adventure
First NPC / named creature mention	ALL-CAPS on first mention in each situation, then title case
Trait tests	Notice (–2), Persuasion, Electronics; no invented skills
Information rolls	Fail, success, and raise are always stated
Quoted speech	Table cues in Spoken lines ; not a script
GM Note	Secret; never player-facing

Optional material	Labeled Optional; never gates the objective
PC-specific hooks	Labeled PC hook — Lilly; never the only vector
Wild Card / Extra	Every prepared opponent block is labeled

Opening mood

The night never stopped; morning merely replaced fog with cold rain and paperwork. An ordinary local recording is already becoming somebody else's property. Ashgrove's

lack of anonymity favors Lilly, while every formal question risks warning the crew. At the tower, alert turns knowledge into a choice about what can still be preserved.

First 15 minutes

- [] **Play:** Story Point 1 — 102.3 FM.
- [] **Handed:** Abigail's fresh call from the previous night, Lilly's notebook, badge, issue gear, and the still-shelved Loman file.
- [] **Where they are:** arriving at 102.3 FM on the wet morning after session 1.
- [] **Trouble already in motion:** a purported engineer is asking for the original reel and is ready to leave.
- [] **First decision:** assert custody, copy first, question him, or let him go and follow.
- [] **If this block overruns:** omit arrival color and begin with Ray reaching for the reel case.

Mission in 30 seconds

- **Premise:** A stranger is trying to remove Abigail's recording while Frank remains missing and cleanup can begin if the crew is alerted.
- **Player objective:** Hear the tape, find Frank, and preserve enough independent evidence to prevent the file from being honestly dismissed as a drowning.
- **GM intent:** Human signal method, ordinary detective work, one synchronization gap, no campaign-scale proof.
- **Immediate stakes:** Original custody, fresh town memory, Frank's body, and an active machine record.
- **Starting decision:** What does Lilly protect or pursue when she cannot do everything at once?

Current situation

- **Table start:** RAY HOLTZ is inside 102.3 FM under a maintenance cover, seeking the original reel. ABIGAIL CARR is delaying him. CAL BRIGGS is at the inland compound preparing Frank and the truck for movement, but he is not destroying records or wiping equipment. CHIEF WHITLEY shelved the file only hours ago.
- **If Ray leaves unchallenged:** he takes the reel only if it is surrendered, attempts to warn Cal, then heads toward escape or the compound.
- **If Lilly reaches the compound unalerted:** every evidence category is intact; she gets an observation/intervention beat before Cal detects police attention.
- **If Ray warns Cal or attention reaches the crew:** Cal enters the alerted state and starts active cleanup. The alert itself does not erase a category.
- **What has not happened yet:** Frank has not been moved; no prepared arrest, escape, official ruling, or evidence loss is history.

Pacing dashboard

Runtime point	Expected position	Optional cut if behind
Opening, first 10–15 min	Reel custody decision in SP1	Start with Ray's hand on the reel case
75–120 min	Two investigative vectors are active	Fold SP4 work order into SP2 or SP3
Climax window, final 60–90 min	SP5 compound reached from any route	Doyle supplies broad location after one evidence-cost step
Final 15–25 min	SP6 disposition	Resolve with evidence categories, one presentation roll maximum

Beat	Story point(s)	Table cue
Explosive opening	SP1	Ray is taking evidence now.
Investigation and choices	SP2–SP4 in any order	Technical records, town notice, and access paper alter time and proof.
Escalation or reversal	Any alert, visible at SP5	The crew shifts to moving Frank and erasing originals.
Climactic set piece	SP5	Two Extras, wet compound, live equipment, cleanup clock, body/record preservation.
Consequences and closure	SP6	Evidence retained determines the defensible disposition.

Five-beat dashboard

3–4 hour core: keep SP1, SP2, SP5, and SP6; compress SP3 to Nancy plus one witness and fold SP4's work-order

facts into that witness/records pass.

Climax situation

- **Location:** inland tower compound; delivered in Story Point 5.
- **Opposition (Wild Cards / Extras):** Ray Holtz and Cal Briggs, both Extras; both complete profiles live in SP5.
- **Environment and interactive features:** wet concrete/metal, low light, chain-link, truck, outbuilding, breakers, live rack, fire/bin, two exits.
- **Urgency / countdown:** unalerted arrival begins with all categories intact and one observation/intervention beat. Once alerted, take one cleanup step after each round or substantial unopposed delay.
- **Secondary objective besides defeating everyone:** preserve Frank's body and/or an original signal record; arrest alone does not preserve either.
- **Situation payload:** speech, both complete Extra profiles, and rules live in Story Point 5.
- **Boundary note:** this index adds no secret payload; SP5 holds the compound truth, and no result identifies remote ownership.
- **If time is short:** if alerted, begin with the paper log already lost; if unalerted, keep all categories and compress the observation to one decision before detection. Run the remaining clock; do not replace the climax with an automatic arrest.

Story Point 1 - 102.3 FM: Tape in Motion

Mood (table): Paraphrase only what Lilly perceives now.

- **Climate:** Cold rain beads on the studio glass and follows coats inside.
- **See:** A cramped board, reel boxes, a machine still warm, and a stranger's form on Abigail's desk.
- **Hear:** Low monitor music, spool hiss, and a telephone receiver settling into place.
- **Feel:** A normal workroom made abruptly proprietary.
- **Goal:** decide custody and obtain a usable first reading of the recording without requiring any one choice.
- **Situation now:** **ABIGAIL CARR** wants the recording heard and her job protected. **RAY HOLTZ** says he is collecting it for maintenance. He leaves within minutes if Lilly tests the cover.
- **Spoken lines (Abigail):** *"I called because I wanted somebody to hear it, not because I wanted the tape walking out the door."*
- **Spoken lines (Ray):** *"Station manager signs, I take it. Otherwise I write down that you refused service."*
- **Discoverable:**

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise
Notice while the reel plays	The gap sounds like an awkward cut; Ray edges toward the reel while Abigail can still make a copy.	Lilly marks the cut and hears her surname inside police traffic after it.	She notes both counter positions and that the cut is too clean for ordinary damage.
Common Knowledge on Ray's cover	The form looks plausible; Ray leaves after one pointed question.	His language does not fit a local station service call.	The form lacks a station equipment ID and its callback is absent from the station directory.
Persuasion with Abigail	She refuses to surrender the original but permits a hurried cassette copy; trust cools.	She documents transfer of the original into Lilly's custody.	She adds the program log and Ray's arrival time.

- **Pressure/escalation:** Ray exits through the service door. If exposed, detained then released, or visibly tailed, he attempts to warn Cal. A successful warning starts the alerted state but does not itself erase a category.
- **Essential information and vectors:** the gap/traffic can come from this reel, Abigail/log, dispatch, timing log, optional mud cassette, or compound gear. Ray can be tracked through witnesses, paperwork, or a tail.
- **Failure changes:** loss of original custody leaves a copy, testimony, logs, dispatch, timing evidence, compound evidence, and the optional cassette route. A burned tail reveals direction and alerts Cal without immediately erasing a category.

- **Reachable next points:** SP2 Records, SP3 Town Witnesses, SP4 Water Authority, or SP5 by following Ray.
- **PC hook — Lilly:** Alertness applies to Notice as recorded on her canonical sheet; Investigator may apply when the Edge's conditions are met. Neither bonus is required.

GM Note: Ray wants the original and an exit, not a fight. He knows the technical job and staging, but Cal killed Frank.

On the radio: 102.3 FM monitor — Stevie Nicks, “Talk to Me” (1985). Ordinary morning rotation makes the disputed silence feel procedural rather than prophetic.

Story Point 2 - Precinct Records: The Missing Interval

Mood (table):

- **Climate:** Wet coats steam beside a humming radiator.
- **See:** A dispatch recorder, handwritten logs, grease-pencil marks, evidence shelves, and an open work surface.
- **Hear:** Recorder motors, clipped radio traffic, paper shifting, and ordinary playback clicks.
- **Feel:** Patient work under an impatient roof.

- **Goal:** compare independent records and determine what the “voice” actually contains.
- **Situation now:** **SGT. DOYLE** can provide dispatch access when Lilly presents a concrete reason. **ABIGAIL CARR** may bring a copy or log. **CHIEF WHITLEY** can impose time pressure but cannot make protected evidence cease to exist. Lilly found the mud cassette in session 1, but its exact custody/location was not recorded: if she seeks it, the GM places it in an evidence bag/property area or uses a short Lake Barrow follow-up, whichever matches table continuity. That optional retrieval succeeds with a time or custody cost rather than gating this point.
- **Spoken lines (Doyle):** *“Play the part before it. Then ours. Don't tell me what I'm supposed to hear.”*
- **Spoken lines (Abigail, if present):** *“That silence isn't dead air. I was in the chair.”*
- **Discoverable:**

AT-HAND STATISTICS

Ray is an Extra. His one complete RUN profile is in SP5, where combat can occur; at the station he flees rather than fights.

AT-HAND RULES

Authority: HR-NFA-002; SWADE opposed Trait resolution remains authoritative. Quick reminder: An unnoticed tail uses Stealth/Driving vs Notice. Failure costs position and heat; it does not erase the route. Applied here: If Ray spots Lilly, he warns Cal. Lilly still gets his direction or warning location.

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise
Electronics comparing media	Matching written times takes one hour; the overlap remains.	Lilly aligns the exact missing interval on two independent records.	She isolates post-gap police traffic as replay, including her name.
Research through logs	A dead-end cross-check takes one hour; matching start/stop entries remain visible.	Program, dispatch, and timing entries identify one interval.	A maintenance notation points to tower access during it.
Notice (-2) on the mud cassette, only if retrieved	Handling creates a custody objection; its work label remains legible.	Work tones and clipped police traffic match station bleed.	Leader/stop marks provide a third independent timing vector.

- **Pressure/escalation:** When either failed result costs an hour, advance cleanup once if active; if unalerted, Cal advances movement preparations but does not destroy a category. Whitley asks why a shelved file is using staff time.
- **Essential information and vectors:** station reel, dispatch recorder, maintenance timing, compound machine state, and the optional mud cassette can establish the gap/replay independently.
- **Failure changes:** alignment becomes less precise, cassette retrieval costs time/custody, or another record must carry the revelation. The cassette is never mandatory.
- **Reachable next points:** SP3, SP4, SP5, or SP6 if Lilly closes with what she has.

GM Note: The synchronization gap proves common process only. It does not reveal ownership, motive, or a national actor.

On the radio: Precinct desk radio — Whitney Houston, “How Will I Know” (1985). Bright rotation continues while the recorder exposes a mechanical seam.

Story Point 3 - Ashgrove: Two Outsiders

Mood (table):

- **Climate:** Fine rain turns awnings dark and keeps morning customers indoors.
 - **See:** One diner counter, one fuel island, carbon slips, and sightlines that cross half the town.
 - **Hear:** Cups, a bell over the door, and strangers described by where they sat.
 - **Feel:** Anonymity measured in minutes.
- **Goal:** use the town's social memory to establish two men, the truck, their split, and the inland route.
 - **Situation now:** **NANCY** can identify who worked early. Diner/fuel witnesses remember an out-of-county truck because it was unusual, not because they know the crime. **HELEN LOMAN** can establish Frank's habits if Lilly seeks her.
 - **Spoken lines (Nancy):** *“If they ate breakfast here, start with what they ordered.”*
 - **Spoken lines (witness):** *“Didn't know either one. Knew the truck wasn't ours.”*
 - **Spoken lines (Helen, if consulted):** *“Frank took his boots off at home. He didn't walk cold mud barefoot for anybody.”*
 - **Discoverable:**

AT-HAND RULES

Authority: HR-NFA-002, Hitting the Books (Deadlands Noir p.29 converted to SWADE Research); no setting module active. Quick reminder: use Research for extended record work; failure costs time, heat, or position rather than blocking the case. Applied here: either listed failed comparison can cost one hour; resolve its single clock consequence in SP2 Pressure/escalation, while written overlap and other media remain available.

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise
Persuasion with witnesses	Questions become gossip and warn the crew; one person still gives truck color and county.	Two witnesses establish the pair and their split.	Fuel time and a partial plate narrow the utility road.
Common Knowledge using Nancy's map	She gives three calls, costing thirty minutes.	She identifies diner and fuel stop early shifts.	She names which witness notices county markings and which saw direction.
Notice at the fuel stop	The bin was emptied; the clerk still remembers direction.	A carbon slip records fuel for the truck.	Parking mud matches the inland utility shoulder, not the lake bank.

- **Pressure/escalation:** each public question makes the outsiders a town story. If that attention reaches the crew, Cal becomes alerted; after alert, additional elapsed time can advance cleanup.
- **Essential information and vectors:** Nancy, diner staff, fuel clerk/slip, station workers, patrol observation, and access-key records independently establish the pair and route.
- **Failure changes:** stealth and time are lost, but gossip itself produces a broad description and direction.
- **Reachable next points:** SP2, SP4, SP5, SP6.
- **Optional / PC hook:** Helen's testimony is optional corroboration of staging and never sole proof.

GM Note: Nobody here knows the crew's technical purpose or remote employer. Ashgrove's smallness is evidence and pressure, not quaint flavor.

On the radio: Diner radio — Dire Straits, “Walk of Life” (1985). Familiar motion sits under a town reconstructing who drove where.

AT-HAND RULES

Authority: core Persuasion/Common

Knowledge/Notice; HR-NFA-002 Patter only if Lilly takes one reluctant person aside. Quick reminder: ordinary conversation needs no roll unless outcome is uncertain and consequential. Applied here: rolls measure precision, time, and whether questions alert the crew—not whether Ashgrove noticed strangers at all.

Story Point 4 - Water Authority: Paper That Does Not Land**Mood (table):**

- **Climate:** Damp paper curls near a space heater.
 - **See:** Rows of local forms, labeled key hooks, stamped dates, pencils, and a telephone directory.
 - **Hear:** Telephone dialing, file drawers, radiator ticks, and clerks moving between counters.
 - **Feel:** A small office protecting its routine.
- **Goal:** establish paper-covered tower access while preserving the ownership boundary.
 - **Situation now:** a **WATER AUTHORITY CLERK** can explain normal procedure. A work order, callback, billing address, and access-key register are available to check; their significance is not established until Lilly questions the clerk or works the records.
 - **Spoken lines (clerk):** *“Our crews put a valve, line, or meter on the form. ‘Continuity’ isn’t a piece of water equipment.”*
 - **Spoken lines (RAY HOLTZ, if detained and asked):** *“The number was on my sheet. That’s all the office gave me.”*
 - **Discoverable:**

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise
Research through paper	The callback dead-ends after an hour. If alerted, cleanup advances; if unalerted, Cal only advances movement preparations. Signed access remains.	Lilly links the work order, truck, and tower access.	A timing field carries the same interval before filing.
Persuasion with the clerk	The clerk gives only normal procedure.	The clerk states the description is not locally meaningful.	The key register shows Cal collected access.
Common Knowledge on callback/box	They look like ordinary remote administration.	Neither resolves to a local operating company.	Formatting shows both were added to an older local form.

- **Pressure/escalation:** formal calls create a trace. If it reaches Ray or Cal, Cal becomes alerted; after alert, additional elapsed time can advance cleanup.
- **Essential information and vectors:** work order, clerk procedure, key register, station service sheet, and truck paperwork establish access and inconsistency.
- **Failure changes:** ownership stays unresolved and time is lost; authorized access and the inapt description still stand.
- **Reachable next points:** SP2, SP3, SP5, SP6.

GM Note: Even on a raise, the callback and PO box remain muddy local paperwork. They do not name or prove a larger organization.

On the radio: Clerk’s portable radio — The Dream Academy, “Life in a Northern Town” (1985). Wintry distance colors the office without interpreting its forms.

AT-HAND RULES

Authority: HR-NFA-002 Hitting the Books; SWADE Research remains the Trait. Quick reminder: extended records work may cost time on failure but cannot turn a raise into information the documents do not contain. Applied here: the ownership boundary is factual, not a difficulty gate.

Story Point 5 - Inland Tower Compound**Mood (table):**

- **Climate:** Cold rain runs across the utility road and beads on exposed metal.
 - **See:** Chain-link fencing and a gate, a low equipment shed, a truck, an outbuilding set back from the tower, and a single work light.
 - **Hear:** Rain on metal, a generator's uneven note, and relay clicks from the shed.
 - **Feel:** Cold and exposed at the end of a service road.
- **Goal:** find Frank and preserve physical and signal truth, rewarding an unalerted approach and applying the cleanup clock only after alert.
 - **Situation now — unalerted:** the gate is closed, the truck is parked and empty, and no smoke rises from the barrel or stove. **CAL BRIGGS** is working inside the shed or outbuilding, preparing Frank and the truck for movement; the paper log, signal head, and body are intact. **RAY HOLTZ** is present only if prior choices put him here. Lilly gets an observation/intervention beat before Cal detects police attention.
 - **Situation now — alerted:** the gate stands open, smoke rises from the barrel or stove, and the truck is running while Cal carries loads between the outbuilding and the truck and destroys records. Ray is present only if prior choices put him here. Each substantial unopposed delay or combat round advances one available cleanup step.
 - **Spoken lines (Cal):** *“Badge stays outside. Turn around.”*
 - **Spoken lines (Ray, if present):** *“Back away from the rack. You don't know what you're touching.”*
 - **Discoverable:**

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise
Notice on approach	Lilly sees one threat before action; a dragging seam still leads to the outbuilding. If unalerted, Cal detects her after this observation.	She spots Cal, the body route, and the signal rack; if alerted, she identifies the active wipe.	She also sees Ray's exit or a live-cable hazard and, if unalerted, remains unnoticed through one immediate action.
Athletics crossing slick structure or securing the truck	Lilly is prone or out of position for one round; no automatic injury.	She reaches the body, truck, or cutoff before the next step.	She also gains Cover or disables movement without damaging evidence.
Electronics preserving the signal record	If alerted, the live head is lost; if unalerted, the failed handling alerts Cal but leaves the head for the first cleanup step.	Lilly secures the head or stops the wipe and preserves one original signal record.	She also preserves an independently timed machine state.
Fighting or Shooting	Resolve normally; opposition gains time toward destruction or escape.	Resolve normally.	Resolve normally; a combat raise does not automatically preserve evidence.

- **Pressure/escalation:** unalerted arrival begins with no category lost. Warning or detection is the single reversal and starts the clock without erasing a category. Once alerted, advance: (1) paper log destroyed; (2) signal head erased; (3) Frank loaded/truck starts; (4) crewmen with an open route escape. Skip prevented steps.
- **Essential information and vectors:** body/injuries, staging kit/footwear, truck residue, machine/log, mud cassette match, Ray's narrow account, and Cal's acts.
- **Failure changes:** each missed step costs one evidence category; protected evidence survives. Incapacitation brings delayed Doyle recovery and a degraded end state.

- **Reachable next points:** SP6; unworked SP2–SP4 remain available if time and custody permit.
- **PC hook — Lilly:** Danger Sense may matter when the compound becomes immediately threatening; adjudicate from the canonical sheet/core Edge, not as automatic foreknowledge.

GM Note: Frank is dead in the outbuilding. Cal killed him; Ray helped stage the lake. Footwear/staging material, body location, and signal gear support the truth independently. Neither man fights to the death.

On the radio: Compound monitoring receiver — ordinary local programming leaks beneath work tones; use no named track once action begins so the signal evidence owns the sound.

AT-HAND STATISTICS

CAL BRIGGS — Extra

Attributes: Agility d6, Smarts d4, Spirit d6, Strength d8, Vigor d6

Skills: Athletics d6, Common Knowledge d4, Driving d6, Fighting d6, Intimidation d6, Notice d6, Stealth d4

Pace: 6; Parry: 5; Toughness: 5

Hindrances: none needed at table

Edges: none

Gear: work gloves, compound keys, rope, truck; unarmed attack Str

Special Abilities: none

Personality: blunt, controlling, focused on finishing movement/destruction

Authority: SWADE Fifth Printing (2023), pp.10–11, 87–88, 95, 202

RAY HOLTZ — Extra

Attributes: Agility d6, Smarts d8, Spirit d4, Strength d6, Vigor d6

Skills: Athletics d6, Common Knowledge d6, Electronics d8, Fighting d4, Notice d6, Persuasion d4, Repair d6, Stealth d6

Pace: 6; Parry: 4; Toughness: 5

Hindrances: none needed at table

Edges: none

Gear: work jacket, service papers, tool bag, flashlight, portable radio; unarmed attack Str

Special Abilities: none

Personality: procedural when calm; at the compound keeps Lilly off the rack while looking for escape or surrender rather than attacking

Authority: SWADE Fifth Printing (2023), pp.10–11, 87–88, 95, 202

AT-HAND RULES

Authority: SWADE Fifth Printing (2023), p.29

Athletics; pp.87–88 and 95 Extras; p.102

Illumination; p.202 NPCs; no combat house-rule override. Quick reminder: one Wound incapacitates an Extra. Use actual illumination; Dark is –4 to affected attacks, Notice, and similar tasks with the listed visibility limit. Applied here: local flashlight/work light may create Dim zones. Failed wet-footing Athletics changes position, not automatic damage. Cal and Ray are unarmed. **RULE UNCLEAR – GM DECISION REQUIRED:** if a tool is used as an improvised weapon, no value is prepared; do not invent damage.

Story Point 6 - Precinct: Disposition

Mood (table):

- **Climate:** Rain ticks against precinct windows.
 - **See:** Frank's thin file beside whatever Lilly actually brought back.
 - **Hear:** Recorder motors, paper turning, and Whitley's office door closing.
 - **Feel:** The distance between knowing and proving.
- **Goal:** state the strongest honest disposition supported by surviving evidence.
 - **Situation now:** **CHIEF WHITLEY** wants a defensible small answer. **SGT. DOYLE** supports concrete matches. **ABIGAIL CARR** wants her station protected. **HELEN LOMAN** wants Frank not to disappear into wording.
 - **Spoken lines (Whitley):** *“Give me what you can sign your name under.”*
 - **Spoken lines (Doyle):** *“Body, tape, times. Keep it to what we have.”*
 - **Spoken lines (Abigail, if present):** *“Put down when the reel ran. Don't put words in my mouth about why.”*
 - **Spoken lines (Helen, if present):** *“Don't tell me the lake took him if you know it didn't.”*
 - **Discoverable:**

Trait	Fail	Success	Raise
Persuasion presenting the file	Whitley contests the conclusion but must retain listed evidence and statements.	He reopens Loman as suspicious death/homicide inquiry.	He signs immediate holds on station, dispatch, and Water Authority originals.
Research assembling custody/times	One seam remains challengeable; the strongest independent pair stands.	Facts, inference, and custody are clearly separated.	The interval comparison survives Whitley's first reduction attempt.

- **Pressure/escalation:** delay strengthens convenience and escape, not secret proof.
- **Essential information and vectors:** body, independent recordings, witnesses/truck, access paper, equipment/log, crew custody/statements.
- **Failure changes:** official wording may remain contested; every protected original and honest contradiction remains in Lilly's custody/file.
- **Reachable next points:** end state and after-play recording only. Night 3 remains an unrelated action case months later.

GM Note: Do not introduce hidden-organization proof here. The file answers Frank, staging, local capture/replay, and the synchronization gap only as evidence permits.

On the radio: Precinct radio — Whitney Houston, “How Will I Know” (1985), if ordinary rotation is audible. It returns the room to daily life without answering the case.

AT-HAND RULES

Authority: core Persuasion and Research; HR-NFA-002 Social Conflict only if the GM deliberately runs a three-round held confrontation. Quick reminder: do not force a subsystem for a single report presentation. Applied here: evidence categories set the ceiling; a raise cannot restore destroyed evidence or reveal absent ownership.

Optional GM lookups

Finding the compound

Any one strong vector gives the broad utility road; two independent vectors give the correct compound without a roll. One weak vector costs time or begins approach farther away.

Vector	Broad route	Precise access
Ray	Followed direction	Unburned tail to gate
Town	Truck headed inland	Fuel time/partial plate plus road mud
Paper	Tower work order	Key register/access time
Technical	Maintenance note near gap	Cassette/timing association with tower work
Direct police work	Doyle remembers the possible tower direction	Patrol check after delay; cleanup advances only if the crew is alerted

Evidence categories

Track categories, not a mandatory checklist:

Frank/body, station or authenticated copy, dispatch original/copy, timing/log, town witnesses/truck, access paper, compound machine/staging, crew custody/statement.

Independent categories make a stronger disposition; no category retroactively restores another.

Escalation and clocks

Trigger/time	Change in situation	Visible warning	Effect on objective body movement
Unalerted approach reaches compound	Every category remains intact	cold fire/bin, idle wipe controls, Cal preparing body/truck	Observation/consequence of that reversal, not new twists.
Ray exposed, released, or burns a tail	He warns Cal	payphone/radio use; hurried departure	Alerted state begins; no category erased by the alert itself
Public town questions or formal callback reaches crew	Crew knows cover is failing	witness mentions another caller; truck movement	Alerted state begins; no category erased by the alert itself
SP2 failed Electronics or Research result costs one hour	Resolve the consequence in SP2 Pressure/escalation	Whitley asks about staff time; weather worsens	Apply SP2 Pressure once; this row adds no additional step
Each alerted compound round/substantial delay	Next available cleanup action resolves	fire, erasing head, truck movement, open exit	Lose one category unless prevented
Lilly requests Doyle and waits	Support arrives and patrol noise alerts Cal	patrol engine/radio on utility road	Alert starts; then one step may resolve by arrival time

Failure-forward reference

Likely failure	Immediate consequence	New pressure/opportunity	Main plot remains reachable through
Ray gets station original	Custody weakens	Follow him or authenticate copy/log	dispatch, optional cassette, Abigail, timing, compound
Tail is burned	Cal warned	Route/direction still learned	town witnesses, paper, direct patrol check
Records comparison fails	One hour lost	written overlap or another medium remains	any two independent records
Witnesses resist	gossip spreads	broad truck description emerges	fuel slip, patrol, key register, station staff
Callback/PO box dead-end	ownership unresolved	access inconsistency becomes clear	clerk, key log, truck, compound
Compound cleanup step succeeds	one category lost	remaining objectives become urgent	protected records and all other categories
Lilly is incapacitated	crew gains movement time	Doyle recovers site later	degraded body/site plus protected evidence
Whitley rejects conclusion	disposition contested	custody holds and contradictions remain	body, originals, witnesses, later review

PC spotlight and safety

- **Opening hard-removal risks and mitigation:** none; Ray flees rather than attacks.
- **Replacement/re-entry option:** no spare PC in this solo campaign. Before the climax, Doyle recovers Lilly and play resumes after treatment with the clock advanced. At the climax, incapacity produces a defined degraded ending.
- **Point after which consequences become fully lethal:** Lilly knowingly confronts Cal at SP5. In an unalerted approach, detection and Cal's warning mark that transition; in an alerted approach, truck movement, smoke, and live equipment already telegraph it.
- **Spotlight hooks by PC:** Lilly's police authority shapes custody; Alertness/Investigator support evidence work; Electronics can preserve the signal original; Curious pushes the paper seam; Danger Sense may warn of immediate compound danger. None is an essential single vector.
- **Safety:** Lines and Veils/check-in as used by the table. Likely content: concealed corpse, recent homicide, drowning staging, institutional dismissal, threat to a solo PC. Keep body description clinical unless the player requests otherwise.

NPC quick reference

- **Abigail Carr** — established radio host; start pin SP1; speech in SP1/SP2; no contest or combat profile prepared.
- **Ray Holtz** — Extra; start pin SP1; complete block SP5; SP1 contains a pointer only.
- **Cal Briggs** — Extra; start pin SP5; full block SP5.
- **Helen Loman** — adventure-local civilian witness; optional SP3 and SP6; no contest/combat profile.
- **Sgt. Doyle** — established police Extra, not statted; SP2/SP6 and possible delayed support.
- **Chief Whitley** — established police Extra, not statted; pressure at SP2 and closure at SP6.
- **Nancy** — established civilian Extra, not statted; SP3 social-map role.
- **Water Authority clerk** — unnamed civilian; SP4 only.

Rules quick reference

- **Authority order:** HR-NFA-001/002 within scope, then SWADE Fifth Printing (2023). No setting module is active.
- **HR-NFA-001:** Lilly's canonical sheet uses 15 post-core skill points; it does not alter tonight's resolution.
- **HR-NFA-002:** optional Hitting the Books, Interrogations, Patter, and Tailing only. It does not activate Deadlands Noir as a setting and does not import old-edition skills.
- **Extras:** one Wound incapacitates (SWADE p.95). Ray and Cal are Extras, not enemy Wild Cards.
- **Illumination:** use SWADE p.102 when darkness materially affects a task; determine the local zone from actual light.
- **Do not import:** setting Fear, Magic, Harrowed, Noir Poverty, Blood & Guts, Gritty Damage, Knock-Out Blows, Second Wind, or Deadlands Noir Companion.
- **Weapons:** opposition has no firearm. Lilly's service pistol remains on her canonical sheet and must use the verified SWADE modern-firearms table if exact values are needed; do not invent them here.

GM secrets

- Frank is dead in the inland outbuilding. Cal killed him during a confrontation.
- Ray ran capture/replay equipment and helped Cal stage the lake.
- Barefoot tracks and the mud cassette are staging leftovers; the cassette is work media. Its exact post-session-1 custody/location was not recorded, so use the optional evidence-bag/property-area or Lake Barrow follow-up route that matches table continuity.
- Lilly's name came from replayed local police traffic.
- Independent records share one precise synchronization gap.
- The work order allows access but does not resolve operating ownership.
- GM-only campaign boundary: no player-facing evidence here names ClearWave, the consortium, the Correction, or a national organization. Ray and Cal cannot supply that proof.
- Preparation is not history. Record only outcomes actually played.

End states

- **Full success:** Frank and an original signal record are preserved; the synchronized interval and local access trail are documented; both crewmen are contained or identified.
- **Costly success:** murder is provable, but one original is erased or one crewman escapes.
- **Partial success:** staging and the repeated gap are established while the body is moved or official disposition remains contested.
- **Failure:** the crew moves Frank and Whitley's drowning/missing-person narrative strengthens; Lilly retains every independent item she protected.
- **Unexpected resolution:** Ray turns on Cal, townspeople converge, or Lilly chooses evidence over arrest; count surviving evidence categories and keep ownership muddy.
- **Rewards / advancement:** award campaign advancement only under the table's normal SWADE cadence. Fictional reward is the strongest defensible Loman disposition, preserved evidence, and earned trust from relevant people.
- **Continuing hook:** the synchronization gap is a durable seam, but this case ends locally. Night 3 is an unrelated action case months later.
- **Consequences to record after play:** Frank/body status; Ray/Cal status; preserved originals/copies; exact official disposition; Abigail/Helen/Doyle/Whitley reactions; whether Lilly established the gap.

Table checklist

- [x] Runtime header matches ADVENTURE.md.
- [x] Compile follows templates/adventure/SKELETON.md document order.
- [x] QUALITY.md scores 108/120; coherence passed with logic summary.
- [x] No inactive setting material is active.
- [x] Notation is filled and followed.
- [x] Prepared stats/rules cite active authority or mark uncertainty.
- [x] Mechanics sit beside the situation where used.
- [x] Every situation with speakers has quoted lines and every secret has a GM Note.
- [x] Essential information has independent vectors.
- [x] Failures change time, heat, custody, position, or evidence.
- [x] Early removal has mitigation and re-entry handling.
- [x] First 15 minutes is an index checklist with live trouble and no speech/stats.
- [x] One home per payload inside this file.
- [x] Five-beat dashboard is not a visit order.
- [x] Climax combines opposition, environment, urgency, and preservation objectives.
- [x] Pacing cuts include a 3–4 hour core.
- [x] End states provide complete local closure.
- [x] GM-only information is clearly marked.
- [x] No prepared event is written as though it occurred.

After play - do not treat as prep

Do not create a recap now. After the session, record only actual events, unresolved questions, rulings, character

changes, and reviewed canon candidates. Reconcile campaign continuity only after play.